TOPIC REPORTS: AI

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

News, Sep – Oct 2026

AI · ICT INDUSTRY · INNOVATION ECOSYSTEM

Algeria · Angola · Benin · Botswana · Burkina Faso · Burundi · Chad · Comoros · Cote d'Ivoire · Djibouti · DR Congo · Egypt · Eswatini · Ghana · Guinea · Kenya · Lesotho · Madagascar · Malawi · Mali · Mauritania · Mauritius · Morocco · Namibia · Nigeria · Rwanda · Senegal · Seychelles · Sierra Leone · Somalia · South Africa · Tanzania · Togo · Tunisia · Uganda · Zambia · Zimbabwe

Algeria

NATIONAL AI STRATEGY

- **Le ministre de l'Enseignement superieur et de la Recherche scientifique preside la premiere reunion de coordination consacree a la mise en oeuvre de la strategie nationale de l'intelligence artificielle** — Ministere de l'Enseignement superieur et de la Recherche scientifique (Algerie), 8 September 2026

  Algeria's higher education minister, Kamel Baddari, chaired an inter-ministerial meeting on 8 September 2026 on implementing the national artificial intelligence strategy, following a first session on 5 August. It created five thematic commissions, approved a national research centre for AI and data, planned an AI-based tax administration system and set a target of 50,000 AI specialists trained by 2030.

- **AI Strategy Moves to Implementation Phase** — DZWatch, 22 September 2026

  A follow-up meeting on Algeria's national AI strategy approved an updated draft decree creating a National Research Centre for Artificial Intelligence and Data, which now goes through legal procedures. Committees set 17 infrastructure and 14 data operations for 2026 and 85 training operations. The meeting date and chair are not stated.

NATIONAL HIGH-PERFORMANCE COMPUTING AND AI PROGRAMME TO 2030

- **Le ministre de l'Enseignement supérieur et de la Recherche scientifique préside une séance de travail consacrée à la mobilisation des financements nationaux et au développement des infrastructures de calcul haute performance et d'intelligence artificielle** — Ministère de l'Enseignement supérieur et de la Recherche scientifique (Algérie), 19 October 2026

  Algeria's higher-education ministry agreed on 19 October 2026 with public and private companies to set up a joint framework for drafting a 2030 roadmap to finance GPU-based high-performance computing and AI research capacity. Its four aims are company co-funding of GPUs, research steered to economic needs, a stronger national AI and data centre, and recruiting diaspora talent.

Angola

ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE PLATFORM FOR THE PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

- **Executivo desembolsa USD 6 milhões para plataforma de inteligência artificial na administração pública** — Portal de T.I, 1 September 2026

  Angola's President João Lourenço authorised US$6m for an AI platform for public administration, by Despacho Presidencial 342/26 of 27 August, with a public tender to buy and implement it. The platform is to run on national computing infrastructure and comes with an AI governance framework and staff training. It falls under the World Bank-financed Angola Digital Acceleration Project, alongside a US$13m interoperability platform authorised the same day.

- **O pais avanca para uma Administracao Publica com Inteligencia Artificial** — Portal de T.I (pti.ao), 8 September 2026

  Angola authorised US$6 million of World Bank money for an artificial-intelligence platform for the public sector under Presidential Order no. 342/26. The funding runs through the Projecto de Aceleracao Digital de Angola and sits in a sequence of recent authorisations covering public digital infrastructure, interoperability, digital skills and government cybersecurity.

Benin

DEDICATED AI LEGISLATION

- **Billet juridique sur la conformité juridique, une condition de réussite du déploiement des systèmes d'intelligence artificielle** — Agence des systèmes d'information et du numérique (ASIN), République du Bénin, 1 September 2026

  Benin's digital agency ASIN argued in its September 2026 quarterly bulletin that AI systems need rules on governance, liability and compliance beyond the digital code and data-protection law. It proposes risk-based regulation on the EU AI Act's four tiers and a national classification of AI systems as prohibited, subject to reinforced assessment, or deployable under transparency duties. No legal vehicle, authority or timetable is named.

NATIONAL AI AND BIG-DATA STRATEGY

- **Gouvernance de l'IA : le Bénin doit transformer son avance en résultats** — La Nation, 1 September 2026

  Benin placed third in the first Africa AI Governance Index, which scores all 54 African states across eight domains. The accompanying argument is that a governance lead has yet to become anything citizens can point to.

AFRICAN-LANGUAGE MODEL TRACK AT THE NATIONAL AI MEETING

- **IA / NUMÉRIQUE: Les langues africaines entrent dans la course à l'IA** — La Nation, 7 September 2026

  The Beninese edition of a continental machine-learning meeting opens a track on large language models and low-resource African language corpora, at Cotonou from 10 to 12 September.

AI-ASSISTED MALARIA DIAGNOSIS IN REFERRAL HOSPITALS

- **Paludisme : le Bénin intègre l'IA dans son dispositif national de diagnostic** — wearetech.africa, 8 September 2026

  Benin's health ministry has contracted the South Korean firm Noul to put twenty AI-assisted malaria diagnostic devices into the main public referral hospitals, moving the miLab MAL system from individual facilities into the national malaria control programme, which has classified it as a point-of-service diagnostic. The device automates blood-smear preparation, digitisation and image analysis; the supporting evidence is the vendor's account of a 2025 evaluation in 211 children, and the award date is not established.

NATIONAL-LANGUAGE VOICE DATA COLLECTION

- **NUMÉRIQUE/LANGUES BÉNINOISES : 700 heures de fongbé pour l'IA : après les voix, la question des données** — La Nation, 8 September 2026

  Benin's 'J'aime Ma Langue' project, run by the state digital agency ASIN with the Institute for Inclusive Digital Africa, collected 700 hours of Fongbe speech from 2,400 contributors in more than 20 localities to train AI in Beninese languages, reported on 8 September 2026. ASIN paid contributors more than 5.8m CFA francs. The article asks how consent, reuse and access to the data will be governed.

Botswana

AI CLINICAL DECISION SUPPORT THROUGH THE BOTSWANA-UPENN PARTNERSHIP

- **OpenEvidence and Penn Medicine partner to extend AI clinical decision support to Botswana** — YourBotswana, 18 September 2026

  OpenEvidence and Penn Medicine announced on 15 September 2026 a partnership to deploy OpenEvidence's AI clinical decision-support platform to Penn's clinicians and to extend it to Botswana through the Botswana-UPenn Partnership. A customised set of tools is to be built with the partnership's clinicians. No timetable, site count or cost for Botswana is given.

Burkina Faso

L'ESSENTIEL.BF AI NEWS PLATFORM (FRENCH AND MOORE)

- **L'Essentiel.bf : Une nouvelle plateforme numérique pour s'informer en français et en mooré** — leFaso.net, 15 October 2026

  Burkina Faso's AI centre of excellence, CITADEL, and its Data Lab launched L'Essentiel.bf, a free web and mobile service. It uses AI to summarise four national news outlets every 15 minutes in French and Mooré, as text and audio.

Burundi

NATIONAL AI STRATEGY 2026-2030

- **Intelligence artificielle : à Séoul, le Burundi présente ses ambitions** — wearetech.africa, 10 September 2026

  Burundi presented the ambitions of its national artificial intelligence strategy at the Korea-Africa economic cooperation ministerial in Seoul, seeking the financing and partnerships to turn it into concrete projects. The strategy, validated in April, provides for strengthening connectivity, data infrastructure and local skills; the country's digital capacity remains limited.

Chad

NATIONAL DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION AND ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE STRATEGY (SNTD 2026-2031)

- **Chad moves towards adopting its national artificial intelligence strategy** — United Nations Economic Commission for Africa, 8 October 2026

  Chad pre-validated its draft National Artificial Intelligence Strategy at a workshop in N'Djamena on 8 October 2026. The UN Economic Commission for Africa led the drafting with the digital economy ministry. The draft sets AI priorities for 2027–2035 in agriculture, public administration, security and defence, education and health, and is to go to government by the end of 2026.

- **La souveraineté au bout de l'algorithme et du guichet | CamerPressAgency** — CamerPressAgency, 9 October 2026

  An unsigned CamerPressAgency editorial reports that a workshop to pre-validate Chad's National Artificial Intelligence Strategy opened in N'Djamena on 8 October 2026, aiming at what it calls ethical, frugal and sovereign AI. It links this to restructuring of the national postal company STPE under the Tchad Connexion 2030 plan, including a possible postal bank. No budget or timetable is given.

Comoros

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE READINESS EVALUATION

- **Intelligence artificielle I Le diagnostic Ram 2.0 révèle les défis des Comores** — Al-watwan, 2 October 2026

  Comoros presented its UNESCO AI readiness assessment, RAM 2.0, prepared with UNESCO and Japan, at the fourth forum on AI ethics in Riyadh on 14–17 September 2026. It places the country at an emerging stage, with no national AI strategy, no AI-specific law and no independent ethics body, and makes 23 recommendations to 2030.

Cote d'Ivoire

STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP WITH A FOREIGN MODEL DEVELOPER

- **Transformation Numerique : La Cote d'Ivoire et Mistral Renforcent leur Cooperation pour une Intelligence Artificielle au Service des Ivoiriens** — Portail Officiel du Gouvernement de Côte d'Ivoire (distribué par APO Group / Africa Newsroom), 2 September 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire's Ministry of Digital Transition published its own communiqué on the strategic partnership it signed with the French AI company Mistral on 17 August in Abidjan. The work is a study and strategic audit of the national AI ecosystem, mapping the actors and resources available, and sits inside the Feuille de Route Numérique 2026-2028 and its forty structuring projects. No sum is stated and no financier of the audit is named.

IMPACT IA NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE CONFERENCE

- **Côte d'Ivoire : le ministre Djibril Ouattara appelle à passer de la stratégie à l'exécution de l'intelligence artificielle** — Agence Ivoirienne de Presse, 10 September 2026

  Cote d'Ivoire's digital transition minister called for a move from artificial intelligence strategy to execution at the opening of the second national AI conference in Abidjan. It now falls to the country to take a new step and deploy solutions concretely for people's benefit, he said.

- **Impact IA 2026 : la Côte d'Ivoire veut passer de la stratégie à l'exécution** — Linfodrome, 10 September 2026

  The second edition of Cote d'Ivoire's national conference on artificial intelligence opened in Abidjan under the Prime Minister's patronage, on the initiative of the digital transition and technological innovation ministry. Accounts of the event differ on which day it opened.

- **Intelligence artificielle : la Cote d'Ivoire retient 77 priorites et se donne trois semaines pour passer a l'action** — Le Meridien, 11 September 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire selected 77 priority artificial intelligence use cases at the IMPACT IA 2026 conference in Abidjan, which closed on 11 September 2026, covering public administration, agriculture, health and education. Digital minister Djibril Ouattara said a national roadmap with financing is to be adopted at a further meeting in three weeks. The government plans to own specialised AI models adapted to local languages and conditions.

NATIONAL PACT FOR ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **Cote d'Ivoire : L'Etat et le prive scellent un pacte pour accelerer la revolution de l'IA** — Afrik Soir, 11 September 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire's digital transition ministry, the employers' confederation CGECI and the national chamber of commerce signed a national pact on artificial intelligence on 11 September 2026, at the IMPACT IA conference in Abidjan. The pact is a voluntary framework and creates no legal, financial or investment obligations, with specific costed commitments left to later work. Signatory firms undertake to join a national AI alliance.

NATIONAL ALLIANCE FOR AI PACT

- **Côte d'Ivoire government and private sector sign national AI pact** — TechReviewAfrica, 14 September 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire's digital transition minister Djibril Ouattara signed a National Alliance for Artificial Intelligence Pact with the heads of the employers' confederation CGECI and the Chamber of Commerce and Industry on 11 September 2026, at the close of IMPACT AI 2026 in Abidjan. The pact sets a framework for joint public-private AI programming. No funding is stated.

OPENSCOPES AIDDIA MICROSCOPY AND MACHINE-LEARNING PROGRAMME

- **R101m UCT project brings AI microscopy to Africa** — ITWeb South Africa, 23 September 2026

  SOUTH AFRICA KENYA UGANDA

  The University of Cape Town launched openScopes AIDDiA, a four-year, Wellcome Trust-funded programme worth GBP 4.4 million (about R101 million) pairing open-source microscopy with machine-learning image analysis for research on TB, malaria and other infectious diseases. Partners are KEMRI, Uganda's Mbarara University, Côte d'Ivoire's CSRS and Imperial College London.

Djibouti

FIRST NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE STRATEGY

- **Premier Forum national sur l'intelligence artificielle : Djibouti prend le virage de la révolution technologique** — La Nation (Djibouti), 2 September 2026

  Djibouti opened its first national forum on artificial intelligence at the Palais du Peuple on 2 and 3 September, organised by the ministry for the digital economy and innovation under the president's patronage. The framing is explicitly sovereignty: AI as a lever of independence, innovation and development rather than a technology to be received. The forum sits against Vision Djibouti 2035 and UNESCO's readiness assessment.

- **Djibouti se dote d'une stratégie d'IA sur fond de préparation encore limitée** — wearetech.africa, 4 September 2026

  Djibouti presented the main lines of its first national artificial-intelligence strategy, covering 2026 to 2030 around six priorities: data and AI governance, cybersecurity, training, research, innovation and inclusion. A UNESCO-supported readiness assessment presented alongside it classes the country as emerging, with an ICT development index of 61.6 against AI readiness of about 24.5 out of 100 and no legislation dedicated to artificial intelligence beyond the data-protection provisions of the digital code.

- **Intelligence artificielle : Djibouti lance sa premiere strategie nationale** — L'Observateur, 8 September 2026

  Djibouti presented its first national artificial intelligence strategy for 2026–2030, built on six areas: data and AI governance, cybersecurity, training, research, innovation and inclusion. A readiness assessment carried out with UNESCO rates the country 'emerging', at about 24.5 out of 100, against an ICT development index of 61.6. No budget is given.

FIRST NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE FORUM

- **Intelligence artificielle : les acteurs d'un écosystème en construction** — La Nation, 3 September 2026

  Djibouti's daily La Nation profiled participants at the country's first national forum on artificial intelligence. They include HOOM, a Djiboutian learning app used by more than 4,500 final-year secondary pupils (about 57% of the cohort), the chatbot Bouho AI, which works in Somali, Afar and Arabic, the EU-funded École 42 Djibouti, and Djibouti Telecom, which sponsored the forum.

- **Premier Concours national de prototypage : Quand l'intelligence artificielle révèle les talents de la jeunesse djiboutienne** — La Nation, 7 September 2026

  Djibouti's ministry for the digital economy ran the country's first national AI prototyping competition ahead of its first National Forum on Artificial Intelligence. Of 126 applications, 56 were eligible and 17 reached the pitch stage; the winner, Tech Genius, received 2,000,000 Djibouti francs, with 1,000,000 and 500,000 francs for second and third place.

NATIONAL AI READINESS INDEX

- **Djibouti Telecom forme 35 ingénieurs à l'intelligence artificielle** — Agence Djiboutienne d'Information (ADI), 17 September 2026

  Djibouti's state operator certified 35 of its engineers in artificial intelligence at a ceremony presided over by the communications minister, who cited the national AI readiness assessment run on UNESCO's methodology: it credits engaged digital transformation, strategic infrastructure and a nascent academic base while finding room to improve on skills, governance and research. He called for closer ties between the operator, the university and research centres.

DR Congo

CENTRAL BANK POSITION ON ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **André Wameso à Nairobi : Quand la BCC plaide pour une intelligence artificielle au service des Banques centrales africaines** — Magazine RD Congo-Monde, 18 September 2026

  The governor of DR Congo's central bank, André Wameso, told the Central Bank of Kenya's AI conference in Nairobi on 16 September 2026 that the bank plans to use AI in macroeconomic forecasting, banking supervision, payment-system oversight and decision support. He said an internal audit of the national financial system and a consultation of local experts will come before any major deployment.

AVAILABILITY OF ANTHROPIC'S CLAUDE

- **RDC : Claude, l'assistant d'IA d'Anthropic, désormais officiellement accessible** — wearetech.africa, 23 September 2026

  DR Congo's Ministry of Digital Economy announced on 22 September that Anthropic's Claude is now officially available in the country, both the consumer service and commercial API access. Users had previously reached it through VPNs; the communiqué gave no terms.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE STRATEGY (SNIA)

- **Stratégie Nationale de l'Intelligence Artificielle de la République Démocratique du Congo (draft technique) : Faire de l'intelligence artificielle un moteur de progrès technique et de diversification économique, horizon 2030** — Ministère de l'Économie Numérique / Agence pour le Développement du Numérique (ADN), RDC, 6 October 2026

DR Congo's digital economy ministry has published a technical draft of a national AI strategy to 2030, with 4 pillars and 176 actions. It plans an annual report on AI in the country from 2027 and a minimum of 15% local content in public AI purchases; the text is a draft, not an adopted strategy.

PUBLIC AWARENESS OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **Intelligence artificielle en RDC : la notoriété progresse, les usages s'accélèrent [Target]** — globalnewsrdc, 6 October 2026

  A survey by the DR Congo consultancy Target Sarl of 2,280 adults in the 26 provincial capitals, conducted from 16 to 22 March 2026, found awareness of artificial intelligence rose from 54% in 2025 to 61%, and use from 24% to 47%. Use stands at 54% among men and 41% among women, and ChatGPT is the most used tool.

Egypt

PUBLIC AWARENESS AND USE OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **معلومات الوزراء: وعي المصريين بالذكاء الاصطناعي يقفز من 22% لـ65% فى 3 سنوات** — Youm7, 7 September 2026

  An Egyptian government survey puts those who have heard of artificial-intelligence applications at 65 per cent in 2026 against 22 per cent in 2023, with work the leading use.

CASSAVA AI FACTORY, EGYPT SITE

- **فودافون والسويدي وكاسافا' تؤسسون أكبر مركز بيانات وذكاء اصطناعي في مصر'** — Maspero — National Media Authority (Egypt), 8 September 2026

  Egypt's communications minister attended a Cairo signing at which three companies undertook to establish a large data centre venture and the country's first sovereign artificial-intelligence data centre.

HUMAN RIGHTS COUNCIL RESOLUTION ON ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE AND HUMAN RIGHTS

- **A/HRC/63/L.25 - Implications of artificial intelligence for the promotion and protection of human rights (draft resolution)** — UN Human Rights Council, 28 September 2026 GLOBAL

  A draft resolution on the implications of artificial intelligence for human rights, A/HRC/63/L.25, was tabled at the UN Human Rights Council's 63rd session on 28 September 2026 by 13 sponsors including Egypt, Algeria, Cameroon and Tunisia. It covers human oversight of and remedy for AI-made decisions, digital public infrastructure and open models, and calls for a panel discussion at the 65th session. This is the draft as tabled, not the adopted text.

- **مصر تقود مبادرة لاعتماد أول قرار بمجلس حقوق الإنسان حول الذكاء الاصطناعي** — Youm7, 6 October 2026

  Egypt, with Bangladesh and a cross-regional group, led the UN Human Rights Council to adopt by consensus its first resolution on the implications of AI for human rights. It stresses the right to development, decent work, linguistic diversity and technology transfer to developing countries, and mandates a Council meeting and a report on AI, human rights and the capacity gap. The adoption date is not stated.

Eswatini

FISCALISATION AND ELECTRONIC INVOICING SYSTEM

- **BE backs ERS e-invoicing but demands practical rollout** — Independent News Eswatini, 7 September 2026

  Eswatini's national business body backed the revenue service's move to electronic invoicing while asking that it be made affordable and workable across existing technologies before national rollout.

- **Retail, wholesale sector steps up for e-invoicing pilot** — Times of Eswatini, 9 September 2026

  Business Eswatini brought its retail and wholesale members together with the Eswatini Revenue Service to explain the revenue service's Electronic Invoicing Solution and prepare for its introduction. A number of businesses volunteered for the pilot phase, in which invoices are to be generated, sent and validated electronically in real time or near real time.

- **Three tech firms connect to ERS e-invoicing system** — Independent News Eswatini, 24 September 2026

  The Eswatini Revenue Service said at the opening of the 2026 filing season, reported on 24 September, that three technology providers, one a young local entrepreneur, are being integrated into its TaxCore e-invoicing system. Businesses' accounting and point-of-sale systems will have to connect to TaxCore to strengthen VAT collection. No start date is given.

NATIONAL AI STRATEGY

- **Eswatini seeks responsible AI use through national strategy** — Eswatini Positive News, 16 September 2026

  Eswatini has hired a consultant to draft a national AI strategy, the ICT minister's representative said at a COMESA regional validation meeting in Ezulwini on 16 September 2026.

Ghana

UNESCO AI READINESS ASSESSMENT

- **AI Readiness Assessment Methodology: Ghana** — UNESCO, 30 July 2026

  UNESCO has completed its AI Readiness Assessment for Ghana, one of 77 countries assessed, after three rounds of consultation convened by the communications ministry. The findings are meant to guide implementation of Ghana's national AI strategy.

BOA MI AI AGRICULTURAL ADVISORY AND LENDING PLATFORM

- **DBG, partners launch AI platform to transform agricultural financing** — Ghana News Agency, 11 September 2026

  Development Bank Ghana, Opportunity International and the agricultural lending guarantor GIRSAL launched Boa Mi, a WhatsApp-based AI service giving farmers agronomic advice and loan officers portfolio data, in Accra on 11 September 2026. A pilot with rice farmers produced more than 8,500 queries in three months with 75% user satisfaction. It runs in English, with Twi, Dagbani, Ewe and Ga versions in development.

AUTOMATED ROAD-TRAFFIC ENFORCEMENT

- **How TRAFFITECH-GH will detect traffic offences, issue fines and penalise defaulters** — MyJoyOnline, 15 September 2026

  The Ghana Police Service published guidelines for TRAFFITECH-GH, its automated traffic enforcement system, which takes full effect on 1 October 2026. Cameras and sensors detect offences such as speeding, and notices are sent by SMS from the sender ID GPS-MTTD. Motorists have 14 days to pay through ghana.gov.gh, mobile money or *222#, or contest online, after which a 1% daily penalty applies.

- **Police to enforce automated traffic offences from October 1** — Graphic Online, 15 September 2026

  The Ghana Police Service will begin full enforcement of traffic offences through its automated TRAFFITECH-GH programme on 1 October 2026, using cameras and handheld devices. Offenders will receive electronic notices by SMS and pay fines through Ghana.gov within 14 days. The pilot issued about 120,000 caution notices in 2024 and 2025.

- **Traffitech-GH — Frequently Asked Questions ("Police Invisible Eyes Are Watching")** — Ghana Police Service, Motor Traffic and Transport Department, 15 September 2026

  The Ghana Police Service's question-and-answer brochure for Traffitech-GH sets out how its automated traffic enforcement works. Cameras and sensors record offences such as speeding and red-light running, and the police send an electronic notice of violation by SMS to the vehicle owner. Fines are payable, or contestable online, within 14 days; after that a penalty of 1% of the fine is added for each day of default.

- **The Traffitech-GH SMS spot-fine system: The good, the sad, and the funny - Bright Simons writes** — MyJoyOnline, 4 October 2026

  In a MyJoyOnline opinion piece, Bright Simons examines Ghana's Traffitech-GH system, under which police will fine motorists by text message from 1 November 2026. He reports that the operator, NTMEL, is 60 per cent owned by Frank Osei and 40 per cent by Sensys Gatso, and that fine revenue is split 40 per cent to the operator and 60 per cent to government. He calls for the PPP contract to be published.

CUSTOMS AI ATTRIBUTED REVENUE

- **Customs revenue jumps to $450m monthly since AI introduction** — MyJoyOnline, 16 September 2026

  Ghana's revenue authority says customs collections have risen from about US$350 million to as much as US$450 million a month since an AI valuation system was installed at the ports in April 2026. It attributes the rise to more accurate valuation and classification rather than new taxes.

SIGNTALK-GH SIGN-LANGUAGE TRANSLATION SYSTEM

- **KNUST Researchers Develop AI System to Bridge Ghanaian Sign Language Communication Gap in Healthcare** — Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (University Relations Office), 23 September 2026

  Researchers at Ghana's Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology have developed SignTalk-Gh, an AI system that translates Ghanaian Sign Language into text and audio and back, built for doctor-patient consultations. The work was funded through the Responsible AI Lab's AI4SD project by the French Embassy in Ghana and AFD. No deployment date or hospital count is given.

HUB FOR AI AND DISABILITY INCLUSION (HAIDI)

- **How Africa's AI boom is leaving 100 million disabled citizens behind** — TechCabal, 24 September 2026

  KENYA AFRICA

  A Hub for AI and Disability Inclusion (HAIDI), hosted by KNUST's Responsible AI Lab, and an African Disability Data Network were launched at the Global Data Festival in Nairobi with backing from IDRC, the UK FCDO and AI4D. They plan to map disability-related datasets, build three new datasets, assess how national AI strategies treat disability and fund three startups with grants of up to KES 5 million.

NATIONAL AI LANGUAGE MODELS

- **Sam George tasks KNUST to develop Twi AI model as Ghana plans local-language artificial intelligence** — MyJoyOnline, 12 October 2026

  Ghana's communications minister said national AI language models will be built locally, tasking a Kumasi university to lead a Twi model and other universities to lead other Ghanaian languages. Voice interfaces for farmers and telemedicine are planned; no budget or timetable was given.

Guinea

DIGITISED PUBLIC PROCUREMENT WITH AI PRICE CHECKING

- **Routes en Guinée : Bah Oury veut réduire les coûts grâce à l'intelligence artificielle** — Guinéejet, 12 October 2026

  Guinea's Prime Minister, Amadou Oury Bah, said the government will digitise public procurement and use artificial intelligence to check road construction prices against market prices and flag overbilling, with technical support from Rwanda. The system is to use national statistics institute data and assessments by the major projects control body, and to be operational by the end of the year. No cost is given.

Kenya

KENYA ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE BILL 2026

- **Report of the Standing Committee on Information, Communication and Technology on the Artificial Intelligence Bill, 2026 (Senate Bills No. 4 of 2026)** — Parliament of Kenya — The Senate, Standing Committee on Information, Communication and Technology, 1 September 2026

  The Kenyan Senate's ICT committee report on the Artificial Intelligence Bill, 2026 (Senate Bills No. 4 of 2026) recommends that the Senate does not proceed with the Bill. The 170-page report draws on written submissions from 143 stakeholders and asks for a national AI policy to be published first.

- **Senate committee shoots down Nyamu's Bill on AI, warns of Sh5 million fines** — The Star (Kenya), 15 October 2026

  Kenya's Senate ICT committee has asked the Senate not to proceed with Senator Karen Nyamu's Artificial Intelligence Bill, 2026, after hearing from 143 stakeholders. It objected to fines of up to KSh 5 million and up to two years' imprisonment, and to an AI Commissioner whose powers would overlap existing regulators, and called for a national AI policy first.

AI-GENERATED POLITICAL INFLUENCE OPERATION AHEAD OF THE 2027 ELECTION

- **'What matters is evidence!' Wandayi distances himself from AI campaign praising tariff move** — The Star, 11 September 2026

  Kenya's Energy Cabinet Secretary Opiyo Wandayi said on 11 September 2026 that his ministry neither authorised nor took part in an AI-generated social media campaign praising its withdrawal of a Kenya Power tariff rise. A report found an unnamed actor used the Claude chatbot to produce batches of 50 posts under #PowerReliefKE, and found no evidence of government involvement.

- **Anthropic flags Kenya AI influence operation** — ITWeb Africa, 11 September 2026

  Anthropic's September 2026 report on misuse of its AI models, covering December 2025 to August 2026, says a domestic Kenyan actor used Claude to mass-produce political posts made to look like grassroots opinion ahead of the 2027 election. Many praised energy secretary James Opiyo Wandayi. Anthropic found no evidence of government involvement and said the content did not reach genuine users.

- **CS Wandayi Responds to Anthropic Report on AI-Generated Campaign Praising Him** — Kenyans.co.ke, 11 September 2026

  Kenya's energy cabinet secretary, Opiyo Wandayi, said on 11 September 2026 that an Anthropic threat-intelligence report did not show that he or his ministry took part in an AI-generated social media campaign praising him over electricity tariffs. The report described one actor using Claude to produce Kenyan political posts in batches of 50 and found no evidence of government involvement.

- **Kenyan political operator used Claude to mass-produce election propaganda, Anthropic says** — TechCabal, 11 September 2026

  Anthropic said it removed an account that used Claude to produce Kenyan political posts in batches of 50 ahead of the 2027 election, TechCabal reported on 11 September 2026. The posts praised energy cabinet secretary Opiyo Wandayi and attacked opposition figures; Anthropic found no evidence of government involvement and no sign the content reached real people.

NATIONAL AI COMPUTING PLATFORM

- **Kenya, UNDP move to operationalise sovereign AI infrastructure at Konza Data Centre** — TechReview Africa, 11 September 2026

  The UN Development Programme in Kenya and the Technopolis Development Authority signed a letter of agreement to put sovereign AI infrastructure into operation at the Konza Data Centre, TechReview Africa reported on 11 September 2026. The infrastructure is to support the AI Accelerator programme, green technology and applied research. No cost, capacity or timetable is given.

BANK USE OF AI IN CREDIT RISK ASSESSMENT

- **AI already decides who gets a loan in Kenya. Now decide who governs it** — Capital FM Kenya, 14 September 2026

  In an opinion piece ahead of the National Credit Market Convention in Naivasha, Kevin Mutiso writes that Kenya's 256 licensed digital credit providers have disbursed 8.37 million loans worth over KES 150bn using scoring models. He proposes rules modelled on the EU AI Act, whose credit-scoring provisions took effect on 2 August 2026, but graded by how opaque and autonomous each system is.

OPENSCOPES AIDDIA AI MICROSCOPY PROGRAMME

- **R101m UCT project brings AI microscopy to Africa** — ITWeb South Africa, 23 September 2026

  SOUTH AFRICA · UGANDA · CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  The University of Cape Town launched openScopes AIDDiA, a four-year, Wellcome Trust-funded programme worth GBP 4.4 million (about R101 million) pairing open-source microscopy with machine-learning image analysis for research on TB, malaria and other infectious diseases. Partners are KEMRI, Uganda's Mbarara University, Côte d'Ivoire's CSRS and Imperial College London.

ROADMAP FOR CHILDREN'S RIGHTS AND PROTECTION IN THE AGE OF AI, 2026-2027

- **Ruto Calls for Safer AI and Technology for Children** — ynews.digital, 23 September 2026

  Kenya's President William Ruto called for technology that is safe by design for children at a UN meeting of the Coalition for Children's Rights and Protection in the Age of AI, which Kenya launched with France and Spain in July. The coalition unveiled a 2026-2027 roadmap backed by 23 states and eight UN entities. Ruto said Kenya is drafting an AI and emerging technologies policy expected to cover child online safety.

- **UNGA81: Kenya joins global leaders to promote children's rights in the Age of AI** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

  President Ruto co-hosted the launch of a 2026-2027 Roadmap for Children's Rights and Protection in the Age of AI at the UN General Assembly, alongside the leaders of France, Spain and Australia. Kenya's technology envoy Philip Thigo said Kenya would take the work forward at home, across Africa and globally.

DHOLUO SPEECH DATASET

- **MCAAI drives Dholuo speech data collection to improve AI representation** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

  The Maseno Centre for Applied Artificial Intelligence ran a preparatory visit to Suba ahead of collecting Dholuo speech data to improve the language's representation in AI systems, onboarding participants to its SmartVoice app. The work involves the ACTS-AI4D team.

HUB FOR AI AND DISABILITY INCLUSION AND AFRICAN DISABILITY DATA NETWORK

- **How Africa's AI boom is leaving 100 million disabled citizens behind** — TechCabal, 24 September 2026

  GHANA AFRICA

  A Hub for AI and Disability Inclusion (HAIDI), hosted by KNUST's Responsible AI Lab, and an African Disability Data Network were launched at the Global Data Festival in Nairobi with backing from IDRC, the UK FCDO and AI4D. They plan to map disability-related datasets, build three new datasets, assess how national AI strategies treat disability and fund three startups with grants of up to KES 5 million.

MORAN AI CENTRE OF EXCELLENCE

- **Kenya and Cisco deepen partnership on AI skills, cybersecurity and digital transformation** — Tech Review Africa, 28 September 2026

  Kenya's President and technology envoy discussed with Cisco the Moran AI Centre of Excellence, being developed with the defence forces as a regional hub for AI and cybersecurity, alongside AI skills for young people.

NATIONAL ASSEMBLY INQUIRY INTO AI IN EDUCATION, HEALTH AND THE PUBLIC SECTOR

- **AI in classrooms and hospitals: MPs launch probe, seek new rules** — Daily Nation, 18 October 2026

  Kenya's National Assembly gave its communication committee one month to report on how AI is used in education, health and the public sector, and on the rules that govern it. MPs said there is no national AI framework and are weighing a standalone AI law.

Lesotho

NATIONAL COMPUTE ROADMAP 2026-2029

- **Lesotho First Country to Implement UN AI Blueprint** — Government of Lesotho — Department of Information, 23 September 2026

  Lesotho's prime minister, Samuel Matekane, told the second UN Digital Cooperation Day in New York that Lesotho is the first country to implement the UN AI Blueprint. He said planning is complete and Phase One of a National Compute Roadmap for 2026 to 2029 has begun, after more than a year of assessing compute, data-centre, connectivity, skills and financing needs. No cost is given.

Madagascar

ANONYMISATION TOOL FOR MAGISTRATES' USE OF AI

- **JUSTICE – Un logiciel d'anonymisation pour permettre aux magistrats d'utiliser l'IA sans exposer les données des justiciables** — 2424.mg, 17 October 2026

  Madagascar's Conseil d'État has given all magistrates software that removes litigants' personal data from case files before any AI tool is used, presented at an AI workshop at the Cour suprême on 15-16 October 2026. Built without public money, it is the first step of a Conseil d'État and ENMG programme training magistrates to use consumer AI tools, under the personal data protection law.

Malawi

COUNTRY-HOSTED AI COMPUTE (UNDP AI INFRASTRUCTURE ACTIVATION)

- **Local AI compute infrastructure in Africa: Lessons from six country-hosted deployments on governance and effective use** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Regional Bureau for Africa, 17 September 2026 KENYA RWANDA SOUTH AFRICA TOGO ZAMBIA AFRICA

  The UN Development Programme's Africa bureau published lessons on 17 September 2026 from the AI computing capacity it deployed in Kenya, Malawi, Rwanda, South Africa, Togo and Zambia. It identified 21 AI applications across the six, and found that data readiness, skills, institutional ownership and financing, not hardware, determine how far the compute is used.

SMART CITY SURVEILLANCE INITIATIVE, BLANTYRE AI CAMERAS

- **MACRA and Blantyre City Assembly Explore AI-Powered Smart City Surveillance** — Tech Africa News, 28 September 2026

  The regulator's engagement with Blantyre City Assembly on AI cameras able to detect objects and interpret incidents in real time was welcomed by the city's chief executive and mayor.

- **Malawi backs AI crime cameras** — ITWeb Africa, 28 September 2026

  Malawi's regulator backed AI-powered crime cameras for Blantyre after meeting city officials, with the police and road traffic directorate as partners. No budget, supplier or timetable is stated.

- **Malawi's Telecoms Regulator Proposes AI Surveillance Network for Blantyre** — iAfrica.com, 28 September 2026

  Malawi's communications regulator recommended AI surveillance cameras for Blantyre under its Smart City Surveillance Initiative, a pilot combining number-plate recognition, traffic monitoring and a central command centre at four sites. No cost, supplier, timeline or rules on footage have been published, and the country has no AI policy yet.

Mali

CENTRE D'INTELLIGENCE ARTIFICIELLE ET DE ROBOTIQUE

- **Nouvelles technologies : Le Mali se dote d'un centre d'intelligence artificielle et de robotique** — Burkina24, 21 September 2026

  Transition president Assimi Goïta opened Mali's artificial intelligence and robotics centre, CIAR-Mali, at Kati on 21 September 2026. He had laid its foundation stone on 7 June 2023. The 50-hectare site has six buildings, including teaching space, dormitories and a workshop for building intelligent systems, and cost FCFA 3.3 billion, all from the national budget.

Mauritania

AI-BASED AGRICULTURAL AND HYDROLOGICAL EARLY WARNING SYSTEM

- **تنظيم ورشة تكوينية حول نظام الإنذار المبكر الزراعي والهيدرولوجي القائم على تقنيات الذكاء الاصطناعي** — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 8 September 2026

  Mauritania's national meteorological office ran a two-day workshop in Nouakchott from 8 September 2026 for regional administrators and its own staff on an AI-based agricultural and hydrological early warning system using the AGRIFEMIA platform. The training aims to improve forecasting of climate risks to agriculture and water resources.

Mauritius

AI CITY SCHEME

- **Convention internationale GOPIO : Dhaneshwar Damry annonce la création d'une «AI City»** — L'express (Maurice), 13 September 2026

  Mauritius' junior finance minister Dhaneshwar Damry told the 16th GOPIO international convention in Balaclava that the government will set up an "AI City" within the next two to three months. He presented Mauritius as an investment gateway and risk-reduction centre for Africa. No cost, location or operator is given.

Morocco

AI MADE IN MOROCCO ROADMAP

- **Madame Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni a preside, le 8 septembre 2026 a Rabat, une presentation consacree a l'etat actuel de la feuille de route 'Maroc pour l'intelligence artificielle 2030'** — Ministere de la Transition Numerique et de la Reforme de l'Administration, 8 September 2026

  Morocco's minister for digital transition, Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni, chaired a review in Rabat on 8 September 2026 of the Maroc pour l'intelligence artificielle 2030 roadmap. Its targets are 100 billion dirhams added to GDP, 50,000 jobs and 200,000 certified people by 2030; progress was reported on sovereign cloud and data centres, a Data Factory, a Software Factory and a shared AI platform.

- **IA : le Maroc engage une nouvelle phase de sa strategie nationale a l'horizon 2030** — PanoraPost, 9 September 2026

  Morocco's Ministry of Digital Transition and Administrative Reform presented progress on its "Maroc IA 2030" roadmap in Rabat, including a sovereign AI marketplace, an AI assistant for the Idarati portal and a national e-wallet proof of concept. The roadmap targets 100 billion dirhams of added GDP, 50,000 jobs and 200,000 trained people by 2030.

JAZARI ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE INSTITUTES

- **Les assemblees generales de quatre Instituts 'JAZARI' se sont tenues le 8 septembre 2026 a Rabat, sous la presidence de Madame la Ministre Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni** — Ministere de la Transition Numerique et de la Reforme de l'Administration, 8 September 2026

  Morocco's four JAZARI artificial intelligence institutes held their general assemblies in Rabat on 8 September 2026, chaired by the digital transition minister, Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni. Their founding conventions were approved in the Bulletin officiel in August 2026. JAZARI ROOT covers digital infrastructure, data centres, computing and national AI capability; the others cover education, industry and smart cities.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE ROADMAP "MOROCCO AI 2030"

- **Les principales avancees de la feuille de route Maroc IA 2030 presentees a Rabat** — Maroc.ma (Portail national du Maroc) / MAP, 8 September 2026

  Morocco's digital transition ministry presented the main advances of the Maroc IA 2030 roadmap in Rabat, framing it as the move from design into implementation. The minister-delegate said the national AI conference had been the founding stage and that the AI Made in Morocco roadmap now enters a phase of concrete delivery.

RAIL OPERATOR'S NATIONAL AI VIDEO-SURVEILLANCE SYSTEM

- **ONCF prépare un dispositif national de vidéosurveillance dopé à l'IA pour 2030** — Journal Du Canada, 10 September 2026

Morocco's national rail operator, ONCF, issued a 1.08 million dirham tender for a study to design a national video-surveillance system with AI analytics and central supervision by 2030, reported on 10 September 2026. The study will size cameras, data storage, transmission networks and supervision centres for later procurement. No budget for the full system has been announced.

DIGITAL MINISTRY PARTNERSHIP WITH MISTRAL AI

- **Morocco, Mistral AI release first open-source AI tools under AI made in Morocco roadmap** — Tech Review Africa, 29 September 2026

  Morocco's digital ministry and Mistral AI released their first open-source tools: a classifier that tells Arabic dialects including Darija apart, and a speech-recognition model for Darija that handles switching into French and English.

- **Le ministère de la Transition numérique et Mistral annoncent les premières briques d'IA développées | Maroc.ma** — Maroc.ma (Government of Morocco), 30 September 2026

  Morocco's digital transition ministry and Mistral released the first open-source tools from their AI partnership: a classifier that distinguishes Arabic dialects including Darija, and a Voxtral speech-recognition model for Darija that handles switching between Arabic, French and English. The ministry says further language and public-service models are in development.

Namibia

CENTRAL BANK AND REGULATOR SHARED ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE PROGRAMME

- **BANK OF NAMIBIA, CRAN LAUNCH AI PROGRAMME** — Namibian Broadcasting Corporation, 1 September 2026

  The Bank of Namibia and the communications regulator CRAN have launched a programme to build shared AI infrastructure for public agencies and find uses in advisory services, procurement, licensing and scam reporting. Agencies are to buy AI hardware and software jointly rather than separately, and the roadmap includes AI in indigenous languages.

AI AND SATELLITE CROP-MONITORING CONTRACT

- **US firm 6th Grain demands N$13m for cancelled crop tender** — The Namibian, 14 September 2026

  US firm 6th Grain Corporation is demanding N$13 million from Namibia's government after Cabinet ordered its crop-monitoring contract cancelled for failing legal and procedural requirements. A demand letter dated 9 September 2026 claims payment for completed work, commercial loss and reputational damage.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE INSTITUTE

- **Namibia to launch AI institute to strengthen national capacity** — Namibia Business Review, 22 September 2026

  Namibia's National Commission on Research, Science and Technology said on 22 September 2026 that it would launch the National Artificial Intelligence Institute of Namibia the next day. The institute will run four centres, including one to curate Namibian datasets, and its youth AI fellowship is training about 2,000 tertiary students. No budget is given.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE INSTITUTE

- **National AI Institute launched** — The Namibian, 27 September 2026

Namibia's ICT minister launched a National Artificial Intelligence Institute in Windhoek, made up of software development, datasets, innovation and research centres. It is to work on skills, local datasets and uses in health, education, food security, energy and public services.

INTERNAL POLICY ON CIVIL SERVANTS' USE OF AI

- **Government directs AI policy for civil servants as ICT Summit opens in Ongwediva** — Namibia Economist, 13 October 2026

  Namibia's Cabinet has directed the Office of the Prime Minister and the ICT ministry to develop an internal policy on civil servants' use of artificial intelligence, the ICT minister announced at the National ICT Summit. No timeline or draft was given.

Nigeria

INEC AI CHECKS IN RESULTS MANAGEMENT

- **At Editors' Conference, Amupitan Says INEC Deploying AI to Detect Result Errors Ahead of 2027** — ThisDay, 25 September 2026

  Nigeria's electoral commission INEC said it has begun using AI tools in its results-management process to flag discrepancies and errors in result records before final validation, with every automated check subject to human audit. Chairman Joash Amupitan said INEC has set up an AI Division and adopted an AI roadmap and governance framework ahead of the January and February 2027 elections.

- **Obidients Want INEC To Abandon AI Results Verification Plan** — KapitalFM 92.9 Abuja, 7 October 2026

  A Nigerian opposition movement called on the electoral commission to abandon its planned use of AI to verify the 2027 election results until the governance framework is published. It demands independent verification, traceability from polling unit to final collation and publication of the result forms.

TECHNOLOGY AGENCY ADVISORY ON THE SAFE USE OF AI PLATFORMS

- **NITDA warns organisations, staff against sharing sensitive data with public AI tools** — Nairametrics, 4 October 2026

  Nigeria's IT development agency NITDA warned organisations and staff, in an advisory posted on X through its emergency response team CERRT.NG, not to enter personal, classified or confidential information into public AI tools such as ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude and Copilot. It said such data may be retained or used for training, and that exposing personal data could breach data protection law.

- **NITDA warns Nigerians against sharing NIN, BVN, others with AI platforms** — The Punch, 5 October 2026

  Nigeria's IT development agency, NITDA, published an advisory on 5 October 2026 warning people not to enter identity numbers, bank verification numbers, bank details, photographs or medical results into public AI tools such as ChatGPT, Gemini and Claude. It tells organisations to adopt AI governance policies naming approved tools and data-handling rules.

Rwanda

ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE AGRICULTURAL ADVISORY FOR SMALLHOLDER FARMERS

- **Here Is Our AI Plan to Reach 2.5 Million Rwandan Farmers - KT PRESS** — KT PRESS, 2 September 2026

Rwanda's ICT minister Paula Ingabire set out a plan to bring AI-based farming advice to 2.5 million farmers, speaking at the Africa Food Systems Forum in Kigali on 1 September 2026. She cited the e-Soko price platform, Smart Nkunganire's 1.5 million farmers registered for subsidised inputs, and Tunga, a Kinyarwanda voice assistant on trial at the agriculture ministry's call centre.

REGIONAL HIGHER-EDUCATION QUALITY ASSURANCE UNDER AI

- **EA Universities Rethink Quality as AI Puts Degrees to a New Test** — KT Press, 7 September 2026 EAST AFRICA

  Rwanda's Education Minister Joseph Nsengimana opened the 15th East African Higher Education Quality Assurance Network forum in Kigali on 7 September 2026, saying the region must rethink how it defines and assures quality in higher education as artificial intelligence changes teaching and work. The Inter-University Council for East Africa said a regional AI network has been launched.

STATISTICS INSTITUTE'S AI MODEL FOR CODING SURVEY RESPONSES

- **Award-winner Ngirinshuti on an AI model that serves Rwanda's statistical analysis** — Cenfri, 1 October 2026

  The National Institute of Statistics of Rwanda built a model that assigns industry, occupation and education codes to Labour Force Survey answers in Kinyarwanda, English or French, auto-coding 96% of records in one test. Work that took about four analysts a week now needs one person. The project, which grew from an AIMS and Cenfri training course, won an ITU Innovate for Impact award; a field app awaits further testing.

Senegal

PLACE IN AN AI READINESS INDEX

- **Préparation à l'IA : Le Sénégal leader dans l'UEMOA, mais la région reste en deçà de la moyenne mondiale** — Seneweb, 15 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  The West African Economic and Monetary Union Commission presented a draft regional artificial intelligence strategy at a press session in Ouagadougou, with Oxford Insights' 2025 government AI readiness figures placing Senegal first of the union's eight states on a score of 46.10. The draft covers a common regulatory framework, data governance, skills, computing infrastructure and phased adoption in health, education and agriculture. The rankings as reported are internally inconsistent.

PARLIAMENTARY WORK ON ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE REGULATION

- **Atelier régional sur l'IA : le Sénégal appelle à «anticiper les évolutions technologiques»** — PressAfrik, 16 September 2026 WEST AFRICA

  Senegal's National Assembly hosted a regional workshop on regulating artificial intelligence in Dakar from 16 to 18 September 2026, with members of parliament from Senegal, Benin, Burkina Faso and Côte d'Ivoire. The chair of the assembly's digital committee, Aliou Sène, called for an African approach to AI regulation based on regional cooperation and protection of citizens.

AI APPLICATION FOR JUDICIAL ARCHIVES

- **Senegal: AI enters judicial archives** — APA News, 6 October 2026

  A high court in the Dakar suburbs has begun piloting a locally deployed AI application to digitise, manage and analyse judicial archives, with UNDP and Korean funding. Computing and digitisation equipment was handed to the justice ministry's dematerialisation directorate, and a phased national rollout is planned with no cost or timetable stated.

- **Justice sénégalaise : Pikine-Guédiawaye teste la numérisation des archives judiciaires** — Leral.net, 10 October 2026

  Senegal's justice ministry judged the first results of the pilot digitising judicial archives at the Pikine-Guédiawaye court satisfactory. Recruiting qualified staff and keeping the court platform fed are the open problems; other courts may follow.

KIRIKU VOICE DATASETS AND MODELS FOR NATIONAL LANGUAGES

- **Kiriku Voice Challenge : des modèles d'IA développés pour les langues nationales** — Le Soleil, 16 October 2026

  AI Hub Senegal and the French embassy presented the results of the Kiriku Voice Challenge. It produced 210 hours of annotated Wolof, Pulaar and Serer speech and two openly published models, one for speech recognition and one for speech synthesis.

Seychelles

SEYCHELLES TOURISM DIGITAL AND AI AGENDA

- **Seychelles' tourism minister pushes for AI and data-driven approach to reshape tourism sector** — Seychelles News Agency, 2 October 2026

  Seychelles' tourism minister Amanda Bernstein told the Seychelles Tourism Forum on 1 October 2026 that the country plans to use AI and real-time data to forecast pressures from tourism, with attention to small locally owned businesses. The forum presented Lazio HRM, a tourism workforce platform built for the tourism department by Cloudbay Solutions.

Sierra Leone

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE IN THE 2028 ELECTIONS

- **ONS Warns AI Deepfakes Could Threaten Trust and Election Security Ahead of 2028** — Sierra Leone Monitor, 16 September 2026

  Sierra Leone's Office of National Security warned that AI-generated deepfakes and synthetic media threaten public trust and the security of the 2028 general elections. Its chief of staff, Francis Languba Keillie, called for systems to detect and respond to information threats, and for public institutions to set procedures for verifying suspicious content and protecting official accounts.

DEEPFAKE AND DIGITAL MISINFORMATION CAMPAIGN

- **Sierra Leone launches AI, deepfake campaign** — ITWeb Africa, 17 September 2026

  Sierra Leone launched a national artificial-intelligence and deepfake awareness campaign in Freetown, planned in two phases across all 16 districts. It is led by the Directorate of Science, Technology and Innovation with the communications and information ministries, and funded through the World Bank's digital transformation project.

NATIONAL AI ROADMAP FOR THE JUSTICE SECTOR

- **Sierra Leone to develop national AI roadmap for justice sector with UNESCO support** — Tech Review Africa, 5 October 2026

  Sierra Leone's judiciary and the attorney-general's office are to draft a national artificial-intelligence roadmap for the justice sector with UNESCO, beginning with the security sector. Participants at the convening pointed to electronic filing and digital case management; no timetable is given.

Somalia

SAADAAL CLIMATE EARLY-WARNING SYSTEM

- **Somalia Participates in Africa Food Systems Forum in Rwanda** — Shabelle Media Network, 5 September 2026

  A Somali government adviser, Mohamed Mukhtar Ali, told a data panel at the Africa Food Systems Forum 2026 in Kigali that Somalia's National Disaster Management Agency is building systems to give the government full ownership and control of disaster-management data. He said the agency is working with government bodies and international partners. No system, cost or timetable is named.

South Africa

POLICE IMPERSONATION OFFENCE APPLIED TO AI-GENERATED IMAGES

- **SAPS sounds alarm over AI-generated police images** — ITWeb, 7 September 2026

  Provincial police in the Free State have warned that creating and sharing artificial-intelligence face-swap images of oneself in police uniform can breach section 68 of the South African Police Service Act 68 of 1995, which makes impersonating a police official an offence. It is an existing statute asserted against a new practice, not a new rule.

PLACING ON THE AFRICA AI GOVERNANCE INDEX

- **SA has Africa's deepest AI infrastructure but lags on governance** — ITWeb South Africa, 9 September 2026

  A column by Johan Steyn on the Africa AI Governance Index, published in July by the Nairobi-based Lawyers Hub, which ranks South Africa eleventh in Africa on its capacity to govern AI, scoring 2.10 out of four against Rwanda's 3.25, Nigeria's 2.81 and Benin's 2.58 — the only three the index classifies as having established AI governance. The index scores all 54 states across eight pillars and 80 indicators per country, and finds every African sub-region scoring highest on strategy and lowest on implementation. The argument is that South Africa built the infrastructure first: its draft national AI policy was withdrawn on 26 April 2026 after several cited academic sources were found not to exist, leaving no dedicated policy until revised documents reach Cabinet in November 2026.

OPERATOR USE OF AI FOR REVENUE ASSURANCE

- **MTN turns to AI to catch gigabyte thieves** — ITWeb South Africa, 10 September 2026

  South Africa's largest mobile operator is using artificial intelligence for revenue assurance, identifying leakage where fraudsters tunnel traffic through zero-rated sites such as university websites. Its chief executive said adoption has accelerated as practical applications emerge across the business; zero-rating here dates from the pandemic response.

SARS MODERNISATION 3.0

- **SARS sets out Vision for the next Era of Tax Administration at Tax Indaba 2026** — South African Revenue Service, 14 September 2026

  South African Revenue Service Commissioner Johnstone Makhubu set out the agency's strategy at the 13th Tax Indaba in Sandton on 14 September 2026, putting trust, institutional capability, modernisation and partnership at its centre. He said consultations with taxpayers, practitioners and staff had produced four expectations: fairness, professionalism, responsiveness and partnership. No budget or timetable is given.

STATE AIRPORTS COMPANY AIRPORT 4.0 PROGRAMME

- **ACSA bets R21.7bn on metaverse, patrol robots** — ITWeb South Africa, 15 September 2026

Airports Company South Africa's annual report sets a plan to 2031 to bring AI, connected sensors, blockchain and robotics into airport operations, from check-in and baggage handling to patrol robots and a metaverse proof of concept. The plan sits within a R21.7bn five-year capital pipeline that also covers wider modernisation.

COUNTRY-HOSTED AI COMPUTE (UNDP AI INFRASTRUCTURE ACTIVATION)

- **Local AI compute infrastructure in Africa: Lessons from six country-hosted deployments on governance and effective use** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Regional Bureau for Africa, 17 September 2026 KENYA MALAWI RWANDA TOGO ZAMBIA AFRICA

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FILM AND PUBLICATION BOARD DIGITISATION AND AI STRATEGY

- **FPB plans AI-powered oversight of streaming, social platforms** — ITWeb South Africa, 21 September 2026

  South Africa's Film and Publication Board has approved a strategy on digitisation and AI and plans to try generative AI for monitoring, classifying content and managing cases over the next three to five years. None of it is yet in use. Its enforcement committee fined 21 content distributors a total of R16.175 million in September 2026.

STANDARD BANK RESPONSIBLE AI APPROACH

- **Standard Bank, Stellenbosch University develop responsible AI framework** — ITWeb South Africa, 22 September 2026

  Standard Bank and Stellenbosch University's School for Data Science and Computational Thinking are developing a framework for responsible AI use in business, announced at a panel in Cape Town.

OPENSCOPES AIDDIA AI MICROSCOPY PROGRAMME

- **R101m UCT project brings AI microscopy to Africa** — ITWeb South Africa, 23 September 2026 KENYA UGANDA CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  The University of Cape Town launched openScopes AIDDiA, a four-year, Wellcome Trust-funded programme worth GBP 4.4 million (about R101 million) pairing open-source microscopy with machine-learning image analysis for research on TB, malaria and other infectious diseases. Partners are KEMRI, Uganda's Mbarara University, Côte d'Ivoire's CSRS and Imperial College London.

FSCA RESPONSIBLE AI FRAMEWORK

- **FSCA builds AI guardrails as digital regulation expands** — ITWeb South Africa, 30 September 2026

  South Africa's Financial Sector Conduct Authority told Parliament's finance committee that an AI framework for responsible use is being developed, the one outstanding element of its data and technology governance principle. It issued 140 scam warnings in 2025/26, up from 107, and tripled crypto-provider inspections to 30.

EMPLOYEES BYPASSING WORKPLACE AI RESTRICTIONS

- **The biggest AI security risk may already be inside your company** — TechCabal, 6 October 2026

> Half of 903 South Africans surveyed had got round their employer's restrictions on AI tools in the past year, an Oliver Wyman partner told a cybersecurity roundtable in Johannesburg, citing a report due in November. He said 35% had seen AI-generated work passed off as human, and that consumer trust in AI rose from 11% in 2023 to 44% in 2026.

Tanzania

> TANESCO TWIGA ASSISTANT AND CUSTOMER SERVICE SYSTEMS

- **TANESCO modernizes its customer service systems in line with Vision 2050 goals** — Daily News (Tanzania), 6 October 2026

  Tanzania's energy minister launched new customer service systems for the state power utility on 6 October: an AI-powered assistant available round the clock, a portal and a dedicated unit for large customers, and a 185 hotline, with a revised service charter.

Togo

> REGIONAL GUIDANCE NOTE ON THE GOVERNANCE OF AI INFRASTRUCTURE

- **Procurement Notices - UNDP-TGO-00358 - Consultant(e) international(e) pour l'élaboration d'une note d'orientation régionale sur la gouvernance des infrastructures d'IA** — UNDP Togo, 3 September 2026

  The UN Development Programme in Togo sought an international consultant to write a regional policy note on the governance of artificial intelligence infrastructure, with bids closing on 14 September 2026. The assignment runs from September 2026 to January 2027. No budget is given.

> TOGO AI LAB

- **Togo AI Lab Seeks Technical Lead for Public-Sector AI Projects** — Togo First, 10 September 2026

  Togo's AI laboratory is recruiting a technical lead for public-sector artificial intelligence projects, on a renewable one-year contract in Lome with applications open to 2 October. The lab is run by the public service efficiency and digital transformation ministry with a research centre at a United States university, and the role reaches agriculture, environment and local languages.

> AI ASSISTANT FOR PUBLIC SERVICES

- **Local AI compute infrastructure in Africa: Lessons from six country-hosted deployments on governance and effective use** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Regional Bureau for Africa, 17 September 2026 KENYA MALAWI RWANDA SOUTH AFRICA ZAMBIA AFRICA

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> VOIX DU TOGO LOCAL-LANGUAGE PUBLIC-SERVICES PLATFORM

- **Togo Tests AI Platform to Make Public Services Available in Local Languages** — Togo First, 29 September 2026

  Togo AI Lab put its Voix du Togo platform, built to give access to public services in local languages, to a public user test in Lome. It pilots Kabiye, Ewe and Moba, with the stated aim of covering about 50 languages.

- **Le Togo apprend ses langues grâce à l'IA** — Republic of Togo, 6 October 2026

Togo's Voix du Togo pilot, backed by UNDP, is collecting voice and text in Kabiye, Ewe and Moba to train AI models for public services in local languages. Contributors are paid through a dedicated platform, linguists and communities validate the data, and field agents collect it where phones and internet are scarce.

- **Le Togo collecte des données en éwé, kabyè et moba pour entraîner ses futurs modèles d'IA** — Agence Ecofin, 16 October 2026

  Togo's digital transformation ministry launched Voix du Togo in October 2026, a three-year programme collecting voice and text data in national languages to train AI models, starting with Ewe, Kabiye and Moba. The target for each language is 50 hours of validated audio, 6,000 translated sentence pairs and at least 500 contributors; health, justice and administrative services are the intended uses.

Tunisia

SANAD 2 CUSTOMS RISK-TARGETING SYSTEM

- **Tunisia's Finance Ministry Moves to Integrate AI into Taxation, Customs and Accounting** — News Tunisia, 29 September 2026

  Tunisia's Ministry of Finance said it is integrating artificial intelligence into its taxation, customs and accounting systems, at a conference held by its national finance and customs schools. Projects to be announced include a chatbot for the tax directorate and Sanad 2, a customs system for risk targeting and certificates of origin. No cost or timetable is given.

- **Tunisie: L'IA bientôt intégrée au ciblage des déclarations douanières à risque** — La Presse de Tunisie via allAfrica, 9 October 2026

  Tunisian Customs official Kais Ben Zayed said on 9 October 2026 that AI built by in-house staff will be added to the customs risk-management and selectivity system at the end of November 2026, to target high-risk declarations. He said nine or ten customs services have been digitised and more than 1.5 million declarations were examined in 2025.

BIG-DATA AND MACHINE-LEARNING TAX-AUDIT PROJECT

- **Douanes et fiscalité : la Tunisie accélère l'usage de l'intelligence artificielle** — WMC, 30 September 2026

  Tunisia's customs and tax services plan to use machine learning to target high-risk declarations and audits; a customs risk-model test on 2025 data found about 96.9 million dinars in additional amounts. The finance ministry's IT centre said a one-year big-data tax-audit project on local infrastructure is at the bidding stage.

- **مشروع ميزانية 2027: استراتيجية لتعبئة الموارد ترتكز على التعويل على الذات ومكافحة التهرب الجبائي بالذكاء الاصطناعي** — Assabah News, 6 October 2026

  A Tunisian finance ministry document on the 2027 draft budget plans to fight tax evasion using artificial intelligence, data analysis and linked databases across public bodies, reported on 6 October 2026. It also aims to reduce external borrowing, widen the tax base and expand digital tax services. The document itself is undated and not published.

MACHINE-LEARNING MODULE IN THE CUSTOMS SELECTIVITY SYSTEM

- **Douane tunisienne : le circuit rouge recule fortement en 2026 - La Presse de Tunisie** — La Presse de Tunisie, 6 October 2026

Tunisian Customs said on 6 October 2026 that it has used AI in its risk analysis of declarations since May 2026. The share of declarations sent to the red channel for full inspection fell from 4.7% in 2025 to 2.6% in 2026. An official said customs could be paperless within 12 to 18 months.

AI RISK TARGETING AT THE CUSTOMS ADMINISTRATION

- **Douane : l'intelligence artificielle bientôt utilisée pour détecter les fraudes et contrôler les marchandises** — Business News (Tunisia), 12 October 2026

  Tunisian Customs spokesman Colonel-Major Chokri Jabri said on 12 October 2026 that first trials of artificial intelligence for targeting high-risk shipments improved targeting by 20-25%. AI will also be used to analyse container scanner images remotely, and the SINDA 2 customs IT system is due for completion by the end of 2027 as declarations move to paperless processing.

Uganda

SANDI AI SMALLHOLDER CREDIT SCORING

- **Ugandan Startup SANDI AI Wins Shs190M GoGettaz Agripreneur Prize** — Nilepost, 5 September 2026

  Ugandan startup SANDI AI Technologies won the 2026 GoGettaz Agripreneur Prize of US$50,000, about UGX 190 million, at the Africa Food Systems Forum in Kigali, reported on 5 September 2026. Founded by Sandra Nabakka, it uses AI and farm data to assess smallholders without collateral for unsecured loans. The date of the award is not given.

OPENSCOPES AIDDIA AI MICROSCOPY PROGRAMME, MBARARA UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

- **R101m UCT project brings AI microscopy to Africa** — ITWeb South Africa, 23 September 2026

  SOUTH AFRICA KENYA CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  The University of Cape Town launched openScopes AIDDiA, a four-year, Wellcome Trust-funded programme worth GBP 4.4 million (about R101 million) pairing open-source microscopy with machine-learning image analysis for research on TB, malaria and other infectious diseases. Partners are KEMRI, Uganda's Mbarara University, Côte d'Ivoire's CSRS and Imperial College London.

COMMUNICATIONS REGULATOR'S AI SYSTEM FOR FILTERING HARMFUL ONLINE CONTENT

- **Govt Eyes AI Tool to Tackle Rising Nude, Explicit Content on Social Media** — Nilepost, 25 September 2026

  Uganda's ICT minister, Justine Kasule Lumumba, said the Uganda Communications Commission is procuring an AI system to identify and filter sexually explicit and other harmful content before it is distributed online, and that it must understand local languages. The system, its cost, supplier and deployment date are not given.

ENTEBBE AIRPORT AI NUMBER-PLATE PARKING SYSTEM

- **Smarter parking at Entebbe: UCAA rolls out AI camera system, digital payments** — Daily Monitor, 9 October 2026

  The Uganda Civil Aviation Authority has upgraded the car parks at Entebbe International Airport with AI-assisted number-plate recognition, supplied through local contractor Samanga Utilities on Scheidt & Bachmann software, and mobile-money payment. The authority said it keeps vehicle registration records, timestamps and payment logs indefinitely and releases them to security agencies and police under statutory guidelines.

Zambia

COUNTRY-HOSTED AI COMPUTE (UNDP AI INFRASTRUCTURE ACTIVATION)

- **Local AI compute infrastructure in Africa: Lessons from six country-hosted deployments on governance and effective use** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Regional Bureau for Africa, 17 September 2026 KENYA MALAWI RWANDA SOUTH AFRICA TOGO AFRICA

  The UN Development Programme's Africa bureau published lessons on 17 September 2026 from the AI computing capacity it deployed in Kenya, Malawi, Rwanda, South Africa, Togo and Zambia. It identified 21 AI applications across the six, and found that data readiness, skills, institutional ownership and financing, not hardware, determine how far the compute is used.

NJILA.AI CAREER-GUIDANCE PLATFORM

- **Zambia Pilots AI Career Guidance Platform to Bridge Youth Skills Gap** — Tech Africa News, 12 October 2026

  Zambia's technology ministry is piloting Njila.ai, an artificial-intelligence career-guidance platform, in the technical and vocational training system under a World Bank-backed skills project. The pilot is expected to reach more than 17,000 young people, and feedback is to decide any wider rollout.

AI PILOT ON LUSAKA'S NON-REVENUE WATER

- **Lusaka's water is about to get smarter** — United Nations Development Programme (Zambia), 14 October 2026

  UNDP Zambia and the Lusaka Water Supply and Sanitation Company launched a pilot that will use AI on the utility's production, metering, billing and network data to find where water is lost. The work will run on the timbuktoo EDGE sovereign compute node at the University of Zambia AI UniPod; the partnership MOU has not yet been signed and no amount is stated.

Zimbabwe

OPERATOR INDIGENOUS-LANGUAGE CUSTOMER CHATBOTS

- **Econet Ai nears completion of Ndebele-speaking chatbot** — CITE Zimbabwe, 6 September 2026

  Econet Ai, a subsidiary of Econet Wireless Zimbabwe, said its Ndebele-speaking customer-support chatbot will be phased in from September 2026 and be fully conversational by the end of the year. Its Shona chatbot Yamurai already handles more than 70% of enquiries alongside about 600 contact-centre staff; Tonga, Swahili, Mandarin and French are planned.

SMART TRAFFIC MANAGEMENT SYSTEM (ZRP SMART POLICING PROGRAMME)

- **Govt pursues traffic violators as 4m offences caught on camera** — Zimbabwe Situation (source: Herald), 27 September 2026

  Harare's AI-powered traffic cameras had recorded more than four million violations by the end of September 2026, up from 2.3 million in mid-August, and Zimbabwe's police have begun calling offenders in to pay fines after verification, reported on 27 September. Twenty cameras are installed under the first phase of a home affairs programme with TelOne, and more than 300 are planned for the capital.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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